they denoted themselves as ‘Bharatiya’, or ‘Indic’, or negated the word ‘Hindu’, and ‘whatever may be their mode of worship, language, food habits, lifestyle, and native place’, it would not ‘make any difference’ and they ‘are also acceptable to the Sangh’, he concluded.[47]

There is a difference between this cultural conception and the Savarkarite tradition, which feeds vicious and hateful anti-minority feelings, as Dasgupta wrote soon after the demolition of the Babri Masjid.[48] It is precisely these tensions and fissures at the ground-level—as well as the fears of minority groups who do not accept the Hindutva claim of cultural primacy—that the RSS and the BJP will have to resolve.